Your End of Tenancy Check Out

NICHOLSON GROUP
Reimagining the rental experience

In accordance with the terms of your tenancy agreement you have three main obligations to consider when ending your tenancy:

1. **Giving proper written notice to us. A minimum of two months' notice is required in writing of your intention to vacate the property which should always start on a rent payment date and cannot end before the end of a fixed term. Please give notice in the Nicholson Living app or, if you cannot, email office@nicholsongroup.co.uk. Any questions, contact us.**
2. **The property and contents should be handed back in the same condition as they were at the beginning of the tenancy - allowing for normal wear and tear of course. This includes cleaning, and we often say that work on the principle that you are to hand the property back as you would expect to have been given it.**
3. **The rent must be up to date and all Council Tax and utility bills settled.**

The following notes are intended to help you prepare for the checkout so that the event runs smoothly, and to minimise the risk of misunderstandings that could lead to last minute problems or surprises that can in turn lead to costs, legal proceedings including debt recovery and deductions from your deposit.

You will want as much of your security deposit to be returned as possible, so as long as you comply with all the terms of your agreement your deposit is fully refundable. If you have not paid a deposit you will want to ensure you are not party to any legal proceedings and financial proceedings which may affect your ability to rent, obtain a loan or employment in the future.

The Inventory:
It is a good idea to start your preparations now by running through your copy of the inventory, if one was prepared, to remind yourself about the contents and condition at the start of the tenancy, and to check for damaged or missing items. If you need a copy sending through please don't hesitate to ask.

Cleaning
The following describes in detail what is expected in the way of cleaning, repairs and maintenance:

Kitchen:

1. All kitchen surfaces thoroughly cleaned with a proprietary cleaner and disinfectant, paying particular attention to any stains or marks (see below

for details of a great bathroom cleaning product we highly recommend, made by HG Products).

2. Fridges and freezers need to be defrosted and cleaned.
3. In and around the dishwasher needs to be cleaned out and the internal removable parts such as the spinning arms and filters need to be removed, cleaned and replaced.
4. In and around the washing machine needs to be cleaned. This includes the inside of the door and rubber door seal, inside the detergent drawer, and if the applicant has a removable lint filter at the front bottom this needs to be taken out, cleaned and replaced.
5. Tumble dryer – as above, making sure to clean the removable lint filter.
6. Oven, shelves, grill trays and hob need to be cleaned. Please don't leave cleaning product on the insides of the oven as we might have to call someone out to clean that off meaning cost might be incurred.
7. All hard surfaces should be washed down and cleaned, including the kitchen floor which must not be 'sticky'.
8. Remove all contents from cabinets and drawers (this includes food, rubbish, salt, sugar, etc.).
9. Sink has to be cleaned.
10. Counter tops should not have any scratches, chips and must be properly cleaned.
11. Replace all burnt or missing light bulbs – including inside ovens and in the over hob extractor fan system.

Bedrooms:

1. All bedroom surfaces should be thoroughly cleaned with a proprietary cleaner/disinfectant paying particular attention to any stains or marks.
2. Remove all contents from bedroom including cabinets and drawers. There should be nothing left behind. If there is it may incur a clean or removal cost.
3. Replace all burnt or missing light bulbs.

Bathrooms:

1. All bathroom/WC surfaces should be thoroughly cleaned with a proprietary bathroom cleaner/disinfectant paying particular attention to any stains or marks.
2. Clean toilet and make sure seat hinges are fixed.
3. Make sure the bath / shower is properly cleaned and silicone sealants around the edges and corners of baths and showers are clean.
4. All surfaces should be washed down and cleaned, including the bathroom floor, which must not be 'sticky'.
5. All cabinets and drawers must be cleared out and cleaned.
6. Hand basin has to be left fully cleaned.
7. Clean all mirrors. Ensure they are not left "streaky".
8. Replace all burnt or missing light bulbs.

Living Rooms, Hallways, Garages and Miscellaneous:

1. All hard surfaces and windows should be washed down and cleaned, including all floors, which must not be left 'sticky' or streaky.
2. All the woodwork, skirting boards etc. should be washed down.
3. All soft furnishings and carpets should be vacuumed and cleaned, paying special attention to any heavy stains and marks if applicable. This may mean having carpets professionally cleaned.
4. All light fixtures should have a good working light bulb. It is much cheaper for you to replace burned out bulbs than it is for our handyman to replace the bulbs and charge you for his labour as well.
5. Smoke detectors - should have batteries and be in working order.

6. All sets of keys must be returned. Internal keys for cupboards, doors, windows etc. should be left in their locks.
7. All rubbish or personal items must be removed from the property, and please do not put rubbish or large items in hallways as this could be a fire hazard.
8. If any personal items of rubbish are left within or without the property that are not the responsibility of the Local Authority refuse department to remove, a charge may be made to the Tenant for the removal of these items.
9. We respectfully ask all outgoing tenants to ensure (where appropriate) that rubbish bins belonging to the property are left out in the correct place for the Local Authority refuse department to collect on bin day, and that bins aren't left overflowing with rubbish. It's not nice for neighbours to see bins overflowing, it can attract vermin, and it's not nice for the next tenants moving in to see bins left in this way. Thank you.

Normal Wear and Tear:
Please note that we will take normal fair wear and tear into account when assessing the condition of the property for deposit return matters after you have moved out.

Final Bills:
Please notify the relevant utility companies to disconnect your services. You will need to provide them with meter readings, the last date of your tenancy (which may be after your move out date), and a forwarding address for the final bill. If you do not cancel your utilities and Council Tax they will continue to bill the service in your name, however please do not cancel these before your move out date as this can throw up additional administration work on our behalf to resolve and you could be charged an admin fee. Please also let us know who your utility providers were.

Mail Forwarding:
Once you move out, Nicholson Lettings will not receive or forward any mail on your behalf. You should therefore make arrangements around a month before you leave with Royal Mail to do so, if you have any questions please see: https://www.royalmail.com/personal/receiving-mail/redirection.

Viewings:
In most cases we will be advertising the property for relet so it's likely that we will contact you to arrange a showing of the property to prospective tenants. It is a condition of your tenancy agreement that you allow us to do so, however, we will always give you at least 24 hours notice and will always endeavour to make viewings together for your convenience. All viewings will be conducted in line with Government Coronavirus guidelines.

Keys:
You should return the keys to our office immediately after you vacate the property - if keys are not returned you could be charged to have the locks changed and typically the minimum charge for this can be £120.

Pre Checkout Visit:
Some tenants find it useful for one of us to come and carry out a pre-exit inspection because we can often help to point out any particular areas that require attention prior to move out. If you would like us to carry out a pre-checkout visit with you please contact us and book this separately.

Access to the property after the tenancy has ended:
Once the final checkout has taken place you will generally not be granted access back into the property, and therefore any remedial work agreed to be your responsibility would usually be carried out by our contractors at your expense..

Return of Deposit
The process of administering the return of your deposit can take anything from a few days to a few weeks depending on whether any works are left to be carried out after you move out. In addition, we will need your bank details and new address emailing to us before the agreed amount of deposit can be returned to you.

Miscellaneous information:



Other cleaning products are available but one product we highly recommend for cleaning the silicone and grouting around baths is this one made by HG Products. It can be purchased from local hardware stores and also B & Q, Homebase and Wickes. It is a strong bleach based solution so always make sure to follow the manufacturers usage instructions;



Washing machines:
Our washing machine repair engineer recommends a cleaning product called 'Calgon' for cleaning the inside of washing machines.

Light bulbs:
If light bulbs are left not working after you move out of your rented property, then we will have to call a local handyman to come replace them. The call out charge you would be billed for this is typically around £45 on top of the cost of the bulbs which will be around £4 each.

Oven cleans:
A standard single oven clean is charged out at about £60, and including the hob this can be £75.
The charge to clean range type ovens is from £120.

Carpet cleans:
The initial call out charge for carpet cleaning is £50 then each space (or room) that needs cleaning typically costs from £40 on top.

'Man & Van' rubbish removal:
The Government introduced tippage tarrifs some years ago so if waste items are left at the property that will be too large for the normal household waste bins to cope with then we might have to use a 'man and van' service to remove them. Costs start at £50.

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